# REP-088 · Character names: review and choices

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|---|---|
| Game | Fruit Market 1.7.0 (rules version 9). No game, app or print-kit change. |
| Report date | 2026-11-07 (Asia/Kuala_Lumpur) |
| Type | Naming review, step 1 of PLAN-048 (design only) |
| Request | "before proceeding, i want to rework the character name and naming style, i dont like some names, then can proceed" |
| Status | Waiting for your choices (section 1). The Character Bible and the rest of the design package start after that. |

## 1. How to answer

Reply with three things, for example: *"Style A. Change 6, 13, 20, S3. Also make your Fix changes. Name 13 'Ken'."*

1. **Which names you dislike:** customers by number (1 to 36), shopkeepers S1 to S6, guests G1 to G3. Add a new name if you have one in mind; otherwise I will suggest some.
2. **Which style:** A (recommended), B or C (section 3).
3. **My fixes:** should I also make the changes marked **Fix** in section 4, even where you didn't pick the name (recommended)? Or change only the ones you choose?

## 2. The short version

1. Most names are fine. 21 of the 45 need no change, and 6 more keep their name and only get a new one-line joke (quirk).
2. **Three pairs sound alike** when the crier reads names aloud: Ben and Benny, Wei Jie and Jia Wen (the same two sounds), and Hafiz and Hadi. One name in each pair should change. The pilots, Benny and Jia Wen, stay.
3. **Four titles hint at a hidden card type:** Captain (Premium), Rockstar (Bargain), Dr (generous) and Farid's "Or pay" joke (Bargain). Look E's rules ban that (ART_DIRECTION §9).
4. **Some jokes are about who someone is, not what they do:** Sleepy Zul (an echo of the "lazy" stereotype), a Japanese name given judo, and two Chinese grandfathers who both grumble about prices.
5. **The culture spread is lopsided:** none of the six Chinese-named customers is Premium, and four of them read as thrifty. A rename can fix this without moving any card's type.
6. **Changing a name never changes the game.** Each card keeps its type, wants and prices, because the old name stays as a hidden ID in the code.

## 3. Three naming styles

| | A · Job + first name, tidied (recommended) | B · Name on top, job underneath | C · Crate-label sounds (light) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rule | One everyday job a child can picture, then the first name. No describing words, no "the", no rank, fame or money words. | Big first name in the header, the job on a smaller second line | As A, but where a title must change anyway, pick a job with the same first sound |
| Examples | Sailor Jia Wen · Singer Grace · Stargazer Zul · Bellboy Theo | JIA WEN / Sailor · GRACE / Singer · ZUL / Stargazer | Sailor Jia Wen · Guitarist Grace · Hiker Hui Min · Trumpeter Theo |
| Good | Keeps your approved pattern and the pilot title. The job helps the crier tell names apart. | Quickest to read aloud; biggest letters on the card | Most memorable on a Kickstarter page; matches lorries like "Blueberry Bonanza" |
| Watch | A few titles are long (up to 18 letters) and need a fit test | Replaces your approved "Job Name" rule; bare names that sound alike stand out more | Lost in translation; easy to overdo; same-letter names cluster |
| Changes | 13 titles (4 with new first names) and 6 quirks | Same names as A; every header changes layout | About 13 to 18 titles, the same 4 first names |

## 4. Every customer

Type: **P** Premium, **E** Everyday, **B** Bargain; **g** marks a generous customer (Fixed prices option). The type never moves with a new name. Action: **Fix** (sounds alike, hints at a type, or a stereotype), **Tidy** (title pattern only), **Option** (your call), **Keep**.

| # | Today | Type | What's wrong | Suggested (style A) | Action |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Rancher John | E | Quirk: panning gold is a prospector's job, and "coins" is a money hint. "Rancher" and "Ranger" (#23) blur aloud. | Rancher John · "Lassoes a watermelon from across the street." | Fix (quirk) |
| 2 | Librarian Robert | E | | | Keep |
| 3 | Chemist Daniel | E g | One of five science jobs | | Keep |
| 4 | Rara Jenab | P | Name-only title (your design, allowed) | | Keep |
| 5 | Scientist Aisyah | E | The vaguest of the five science jobs | Any non-science job you like | Option |
| 6 | Delivery Rider Ravi | P g | Rhymes with Devi (also Premium) and opens like Raj. Same job as Courier Farid. 19 letters. | Lifeguard Nikhil · "Saves the day, one mango at a time." | Fix |
| 7 | Diver Mei Ling | B | Quirk punishes soggy fruit, but Bargain customers buy tired fruit | Diver Mei Ling · "Comes up from every dive hungry for blueberries." | Fix (quirk) |

| # | Today | Type | What's wrong | Suggested (style A) | Action |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | Courier Farid | B | "Or pay" is a joke about not paying, on a Bargain card | Courier Farid · "Rings once, drops a parcel, grabs four apples." | Fix (quirk) |
| 9 | Tailor Siti | E g | | | Keep |
| 10 | Magician Kumar | B g | "Three wishes" is a genie, and he has two orders | Magician Kumar · "Pulls a watermelon out of his top hat." | Fix (quirk) |
| 11 | Rockstar Grace | B | Fame word on a Bargain card; also a games and drinks brand | Singer Grace | Fix |
| 12 | Paleontologist Hafiz | B | Sounds like Hadi (#32). Longest title (20). "Hafiz" is also an honorific for someone who has memorised the Quran. | Geologist Irfan · "Fills his rock bag with five blueberries." | Fix |
| 13 | Detective Wei Jie | B | Same two sounds as pilot Jia Wen. A magnifying glass suggests a fussy buyer on a Bargain card. | Detective Wai Kit (the Cantonese form of the same name) · "Solves the case of the missing watermelon." Drawn with a notebook, not a magnifying glass. | Fix |
| 14 | Florist Nurul | E | | | Keep |
| 15 | Dr Priya | E g | "Dr" is a status title; an Indian doctor is a stock pairing; another science job | Teacher Priya · "Brings an apple for every pupil." | Fix |
| 16 | Captain Ahmad | P | Rank word on a Premium card; his navy look copies pilot Jia Wen | Tour Guide Ahmad · "Buying mangoes for the whole tour group." | Fix |
| 17 | Photographer Sarah | E g | 18 letters, may shrink on the card; close to shopkeeper Saleh | | Keep (fit test) |
| 18 | Grandpa Tan | E | Quirk about cheap prices is a thrift hint, and he's one of two Chinese elders grumbling about prices | Grandpa Tan · "Tells you about the old harbour, one apple at a time." | Fix (quirk) |
| 19 | Dancing Lina | P g | A describing word, not a job | Dancer Lina | Tidy |
| 20 | Sleepy Zul | E | "Sleepy" is who he is, not what he does; echoes the "lazy" stereotype | Stargazer Zul · "Names a star after every blueberry." | Fix |
| 21 | Anna the Artist | P g | The only "Name the Job" title | Painter Anna | Tidy |
| 22 | Engineer Vijay | E g | Mild: an Indian engineer is a stock pairing | | Keep |
| 23 | Ranger Hui Min | E | "Ranger" and "Rancher" (#1) blur aloud; weak quirk | Hiker Hui Min · "Hikes down the hill hungry for watermelon." | Tidy |
| 24 | Firefighter Osman | E g | 17 letters | | Keep (fit test) |
| 25 | Sailor Jia Wen (pilot) | E | "Pays in coins" is a money hint | Sailor Jia Wen · "Reads the mango map twice." | Fix (quirk) |

| # | Today | Type | What's wrong | Suggested (style A) | Action |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 26 | DJ Rizal | E | | | Keep |
| 27 | Gardener Devi | P | Rhymes with Ravi (solved if #6 changes) | | Keep |
| 28 | Fisherman Marcus | E g | One of four sea jobs | | Keep |
| 29 | Professor Fatimah | E | 17 letters | | Keep (fit test) |
| 30 | Bellboy Ben | E | Sounds like shopkeeper Benny (pilot) | Bellboy Theo | Fix |
| 31 | Fencer Yuki | E | "One clean stroke" reads like a samurai joke | Fencer Yuki · "Lunges for the last mango." | Option (quirk) |
| 32 | Builder Hadi | E | Sounds like Hafiz (solved if #12 changes) | | Keep |
| 33 | Baker Lakshmi | E | | | Keep |
| 34 | Judoka Kenji | E g | A Japanese name with a Japanese sport ties a culture to a job | Juggler Kenji (quirk kept: "Flips a mango, catches it, pays for it.") | Fix |
| 35 | Herbalist Mira | E | | | Keep |
| 36 | Uncle Hock Seng | E g | The second Chinese elder with a price grumble | Barber Hock Seng · "Knows every customer's name, and their favourite apple." | Tidy |

## 5. Shopkeepers and guests

| # | Today | Perk | What's wrong | Suggested | Action |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| S1 | Rosa | Haggler | | | Keep |
| S2 | Benny (pilot) | Big Basket | | | Keep |
| S3 | Chen | Charmer | Chen is usually a surname, and the cast rule asks for first names. You approved Chen (DEC-040). | Your call; for example Jun | Option |
| S4 | Saleh | Nest Egg | The name is fine. His lines are the only Malay ones, all about saving, and "Every sen counts" uses a real currency. | Keep the name; rewrite his lines in the Character Bible | Fix (lines) |
| S5 | Raj | Bargain Hunter | The name is fine. "Cheap and cheerful!" plus the bargain perk echoes a stingy-trader stereotype. | Keep the name; rewrite his lines in the Character Bible | Fix (lines) |
| S6 | Kiran | Tip Jar | | | Keep |
| G1 | The Influencer | guest | | | Keep |
| G2 | The Gym Club | guest | A group, not a person (fine for a guest) | | Keep |

| # | Today | Perk | What's wrong | Suggested | Action |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| G3 | The Hotel Chef | guest | | | Keep |

**A wider world (optional):** the cast is Malaysia's mix plus English names: among the 36 customers, 12 Malay, 8 English, 6 Chinese, 6 Indian, 2 Japanese and 2 that fit several cultures. For "a harbour where the whole world comes to shop", some new names could come from places not yet in the cast (Africa, Latin America, Korea, the Philippines, Europe). The suggestions above keep today's mix: each renamed character keeps a name from the same background.

## 6. Rules every new name must follow

- A job or hobby a child can picture and an artist can draw as one prop. The joke is what they do, never who they are (DEC-018, DEC-039, DEC-041).
- No rank, fame, money, thrift or fussy-taste words, so no name hints at Premium, Bargain or generous.
- Sounds clearly different from every other name when read aloud.
- About 16 letters or fewer, so the card header stays large.
- No culture tied to a job, and no famous people, brands or well-known fictional characters.
- The pilots keep their approved looks: Benny (broad, bearded, Big Basket) and Sailor Jia Wen (navy, sailor's cap, rolled mango map).

## 7. What happens after you choose

1. I record your choices as a decision with your exact words, and update the creative bible's cast list.
2. The design package continues with the final names: Character Bible v1.0 for the pilots, reference sheets and prompts, card mock-ups and mobile specifications (PLAN-048).
3. **Later, in a separate implementation plan:** the names change in the game, the printed kit and RULES.md. Old names stay as hidden IDs, so saved games, online rooms and every card's type, wants and prices stay the same. RULES.md's list of generous customers is rebuilt from the game at the same time (today it lists 12, and the game has 13; REP-087 §11).

## 8. Evidence and limits

- **Sources:** names, titles, quirks, types and generous customers were checked against `src/engine/data.ts` and the game's generous rule. Sprite details come from `src/ui/pixel.tsx`.
- **Method:** one AI audit of all 45 names, two AI style proposals (Kickstarter appeal; clarity read aloud), and one AI reviewer who tried to break the proposals. Their fixes are in this version.
- **NOT RUN:** a read-aloud test with a real crier, and a header-fit test on a printed card. Both are needed before names are final.